COMPANION TO THE PRD · GAP ANALYSIS

MVP Gap Analysis

Post-Operative Remote Patient Monitoring: where the build stands against the PRD, and what stands between it and a first real patient.

Version 1.0 · For product, clinical and engineering review

Assesses the main branch at commit 44d8caf against PRD v0.1 (14 September 2026)

28 September 2026

SECTION 1

Summary

The product is a convincing demo and not yet an MVP. On seeded data it does what the PRD says matters most: a nurse queue that sorts itself by clinical risk. It is not ready for a real patient, even at one small hospital, because a critical finding pages nobody, patient records are reachable without signing in, and the system has never run anywhere but a developer's machine.

The PRD itself separates a *clickable demo on seeded data* from a *feature-complete deployable MVP*, and puts about four months between the demo and the first real patient. The build is clearly past the first milestone and short of the second.

20	7	6	7
of 33 functional requirements met	functional requirements partly met	functional requirements not met	blockers before a first real patient (Section 3)

What is genuinely strong

- **The core product bet is built.** The risk-sorted queue, the rules engine to its specification, day-indexed and trend-aware scoring, versioned rulesets stamped on every decision, missed check-in detection, alert de-duplication, escalation timing and mandatory outcomes all work.
- **It already serves several hospitals.** Each hospital's data is kept apart by the database itself, and a platform admin area manages hospitals and rulesets. The PRD deferred this (NG-3); it is exactly what selling to small and mid-tier hospitals needs.
- **Enrolment captures a discharge baseline and versioned consent,** and the WhatsApp reminder, signed check-in link and patient check-in form work end to end.
- **Surgeons can change thresholds without a code change** (goal G-5), through ruleset drafts and approval.
- **It is well tested:** 289 backend and 95 frontend automated tests pass.

> **BOTTOM LINE**
>
> Describe it today as a working product demo, or a pilot-ready prototype. It becomes an MVP when the seven blockers in Section 3 are closed. Six are software and infrastructure; the seventh is clinical and operational work that the PRD says sets the date.

SECTION 2

How this was assessed

The yardstick is the PRD (version 0.1, 14 September 2026): its goals, its 33 functional and 15 non-functional requirements, and its delivery plan. The build assessed is the `main` branch at commit `44d8caf`, after the WhatsApp review fixes of 28 September 2026.

Each requirement's status comes from reading the code and running the product, not from documentation. The app was started against its Neon database and driven in a browser: clinician sign-in, the risk queue, hospital WhatsApp settings, and a patient check-in opened from a WhatsApp link through to submission. Both automated test suites were run.

Status labels

Label	Meaning
Met	Built and working as the PRD describes.
Partial	Some of the requirement is built; the note says what is missing.
Not met	Not built.
Not measured	Cannot be judged from code: needs a load test, device test, audit or pilot.

Limits of this assessment

- No load, latency or availability testing, and no testing on real Android handsets.
- No accessibility audit and no usability testing with patients in the 55 to 75 age band.
- No clinical validation: whether the thresholds flag the right patients is exactly what a pilot must establish.
- No legal review. Section 6 flags regulatory questions; it does not answer them.

SECTION 3

Blockers before a first real patient

Every item below must be closed before the product is used with a real patient, even at a single friendly clinic. They are ordered by the harm they could do.

1. Nobody is paged when a patient deteriorates

Critical and emergency alerts appear on the dashboard and escalate on time, but notifications can only be switched off or written to a log. No SMS, push or call reaches the on-call nurse, the backup nurse or the surgeon. The dashboard itself warns that nobody is paged.

Why it matters	FR-23, FR-25, FR-33, NFR-2 and goal G-3: no critical finding goes unacknowledged.
What closes it	Add an SMS (and ideally push) delivery provider to the existing notification queue, and a roster of who is on call.
Where	`backend/app/core/config.py (NOTIFICATION_PROVIDER)`
Effort	PRD: SMS integration, 2 engineer-days; the alert and escalation logic already exists.

2. Patient records are reachable without signing in

The check-in simulator's routes need no login. One of them lists the name and hospital number of every active patient in every hospital; others build any patient's form and accept a check-in for any patient.

Why it matters	Patient privacy (DPDP) and data integrity: anyone with the address can read names or file clinical answers.
What closes it	Switch the simulator off in production or put it behind clinician sign-in, and accept patient check-ins only with a valid WhatsApp link.
Where	`backend/app/api/v1/checkin.py (/checkin/episodes, /checkin/form, POST /checkin)`
Effort	Small; not in the PRD estimate.

3. The emergency call button dials a placeholder number

When a patient reports an emergency symptom, the check-in shows "Please call us now" with a Call the ward button. That button dials the same hard-coded number, +91 422 200 0000, for every hospital; there is no ward or on-call number in hospital settings.

Why it matters	FR-22 and the PRD's mitigation for a missed complication: emergency guidance that does not depend on anyone acknowledging an alert.
What closes it	Add each hospital's emergency contact number to its settings and use it on the check-in page and in the urgent-guidance message.
Where	`frontend/src/app/checkin/page.tsx (tel:+914222000000)`
Effort	Small; not in the PRD estimate.

4. Patient sign-in and reminders are unfinished

There is no one-time passcode and no SMS fallback; patients reach the form only through the daily WhatsApp link. WhatsApp has so far only run in development mode: each hospital's message templates must be approved by Meta before a real reminder can go out. The link's token also appears in server access logs.

Why it matters	FR-5, FR-6, NFR-13; adherence is a high-severity PRD risk.
What closes it	Patient OTP, SMS fallback for reminders, Meta template approval for the pilot hospital, and log redaction of link tokens.
Where	`backend/app/services/patient_messages.py, backend/app/api/v1/checkin.py`
Effort	PRD: patient OTP and clinician auth, 6 engineer-days; reminders and SMS fallback, 4 (WhatsApp covers part).

5. Clinician access has no second factor and no access log

Clinicians sign in with a password only, and nothing records who opened which patient's record. Evaluations, acknowledgements and outcomes are recorded with who and when.

Why it matters	NFR-13 (second factor) and NFR-9 (auditability); expected by any hospital's information-security review.
What closes it	Add a second factor for clinicians and a log of record access.
Where	`backend/app/api/v1/auth.py`
Effort	Included in the PRD's 6 engineer-days for authentication; the access log is not estimated.

6. There is no production environment

The product has only run on a developer's machine. There is no continuous integration, container or hosting set-up, HTTPS, monitoring, alerting on the system itself, or rehearsed backup restore.

Why it matters	NFR-3 (99.5% availability of check-in and alerting), NFR-11 (encryption in transit).
What closes it	Hosting with HTTPS, CI running both test suites, uptime and error monitoring, and a restore drill.
Where	`Repository root: no Dockerfile, no .github workflows`
Effort	PRD: infrastructure, CI, storage and monitoring, 5 engineer-days.

7. Clinical and operational prerequisites

None of these is software, and the PRD says they, not engineering, set the date: surgeon sign-off on every threshold; a named on-call nurse with a committed coverage window; two rounds of usability testing with patients aged 55 to 75; a consent process and a 72-hour breach process; and a regulatory opinion (Section 6).

Why it matters	PRD Section 8: roughly four months to the first real patient, with these on the critical path.
What closes it	Start all of them now, in parallel with the software work.
Where	PRD Sections 3, 6 and 8
Effort	Not engineering effort; calendar time.

SECTION 4

Requirement by requirement

Every functional and non-functional requirement in the PRD, with its status in the build. Requirement text is shortened; the PRD has the full wording.

4.1 Functional requirements

20 met, 7 partial, 6 not met.

ID	Requirement (PRD, shortened)	Status	Notes
FR-1	Enrol with name, phone, language, surgery and discharge dates	Met	Enrolment screen and API.
FR-2	Capture the discharge baseline	Met	Baseline readings stored as the comparison anchor.
FR-3	Explicit, versioned consent with timestamp and text version	Met	Consent recorded per purpose with form version and privacy law.
FR-4	Assign an approved ruleset; surgeon may override per patient	Partial	Ruleset assigned. No per-patient threshold overrides.
FR-5	Enrolment link by SMS; one-time passcode sign-in	Not met	No SMS and no passcode. Patients use the daily WhatsApp link; the enrolment welcome message is never sent.
FR-6	Daily reminder at a local time; SMS fallback	Partial	WhatsApp reminder inside the patient's check-in window. No SMS fallback; Meta templates not yet approved.
FR-7	Form composed server-side from the post-op day	Met	Only the day's questions are sent.
FR-8	New questions marked as new on first appearance	Not met	
FR-9	Binary questions share polarity: yes is concerning	Met	Question wording follows the rule.
FR-10	Binary questions default to unanswered	Met	Review step shows "Not answered".
FR-11	Capture, upload and compare wound photographs	Partial	Photo is previewed on the phone only; not uploaded or stored.
FR-12	Offline submissions queued and sent later	Partial	Server keeps the device's capture time and rejects replays. No queue on the phone.
FR-13	Missing fields recorded as unknown, never normal	Met	Unanswered questions are omitted and scored as unknown.
FR-14	Patient never sees a score, tier or alert status	Met	
FR-15	Cadence change announced on the check-in before it	Not met	
FR-16	Missed check-in raises its own status	Met	Hourly sweep judges yesterday in the hospital's timezone.
FR-17	Every submission gets one tier	Met	Normal, review, critical, emergency; missed is separate.

ID	Requirement (PRD, shortened)	Status	Notes
FR-18	Thresholds, day-indexed ranges and trend from own history	Met	Rules engine built to its specification.
FR-19	A single maximum-severity signal escalates on its own	Met	
FR-20	Moderate findings may escalate on the weighted total	Met	
FR-21	Record ruleset version, signals and ranked contribution	Met	Stored with every evaluation.
FR-22	Breathlessness or chest pain: emergency tier, guidance, team told	Partial	Tier and on-screen guidance work, but the call button dials a placeholder (blocker 3) and nobody is paged (blocker 1).
FR-23	Critical and emergency alerts page the on-call nurse	Not met	Blocker 1.
FR-24	Review tier queues without interrupting	Met	
FR-25	Unacknowledged critical alert escalates after a window	Partial	Escalation is marked on time; the notification is never delivered.
FR-26	Repeat alerts suppressed for 24 hours unless the tier rises	Met	
FR-27	Every alert needs a recorded outcome	Met	
FR-28	Queue ordered by tier then age, decided by the server	Met	
FR-29	Reasons in clinical language; no numeric score	Met	
FR-30	Trends against baseline, plus the wound photo series	Partial	Trends shown. No photos (FR-11).
FR-31	Opening an alert shows the question script for its rule	Not met	
FR-32	Resolution requires one of four outcomes	Met	Reassured, plan adjusted, same-day review, emergency.
FR-33	Emergency outcome notifies the surgical team	Not met	Depends on blocker 1.

4.2 Non-functional requirements

1 met, 4 partial, 6 not met, 4 not measured.

ID	Requirement (PRD, shortened)	Status	Notes
NFR-1	Evaluation within 2 s at the 95th percentile	Not measured	Scored in the same request; not load-tested.
NFR-2	Critical alert dispatched within 60 s	Not met	Nothing is dispatched (blocker 1).
NFR-3	99.5% monthly availability	Not met	No production environment (blocker 6).
NFR-4	Up to 500 concurrently enrolled patients	Not measured	Design matches the PRD's no-broker assumption.

ID	Requirement (PRD, shortened)	Status	Notes
NFR-5	Accessibility: 16 px text, 44 px targets, WCAG AA	Not measured	Large touch targets; not audited.
NFR-6	English, Tamil and Hindi at launch	Not met	Screens are English only; Tamil and Hindi message wording is unwritten.
NFR-7	Android 9+, current browsers, works on 3G	Not measured	Not tested on devices.
NFR-8	Seven days of offline submissions kept	Not met	No queue on the phone.
NFR-9	Every evaluation, alert, notification and outcome audited	Partial	Recorded with who and when; no log of record access.
NFR-10	Re-evaluation reproduces the original result	Met	Deterministic evaluator; fixture patients check it.
NFR-11	Encryption in transit and at rest	Partial	Database connection encrypted and stored encrypted by Neon; no HTTPS deployment yet.
NFR-12	Photos only via short-lived signed URLs	Not met	No photo storage yet.
NFR-13	Patient passcode; clinician second factor; roles	Partial	Roles and per-hospital isolation work. No passcode, no second factor.
NFR-14	Versioned, purpose-limited consent; withdrawal supported	Partial	Versioned, purpose-coded consent captured. No withdrawal flow.
NFR-15	Breach process: notify within 72 hours	Not met	No documented process.

4.3 Goals

Goal	Status	Notes
G-1	Not measured	Detect complications earlier than the follow-up. The capability is built; only a pilot can show it works.
G-2	Met	One queue ordered by clinical urgency; the nurse makes no triage decision.
G-3	Not met	No critical finding unacknowledged: escalation fires, but nobody is paged (blocker 1).
G-4	Not measured	Low patient burden: 12 questions in 5 short steps on day 21, but no usability testing yet.
G-5	Met	Surgeons adjust thresholds through ruleset drafts and approval, without a code change.

SECTION 5

Beyond the blockers

5.1 To meet the MVP as the PRD specifies

Needed for the product the PRD describes, once real patients are safe to enrol.

- **Wound photographs**: upload, storage, signed links, previous-day comparison and the clinician's photo series (FR-11, FR-30, NFR-12). The PRD's main infection signal for days 0 to 14. PRD estimate: 4 engineer-days.
- **Offline queue on the phone** for up to seven days (FR-12, NFR-8). The server side is ready. PRD estimate: 5 engineer-days.
- **Tamil and Hindi**, professionally translated, for screens and messages (NFR-6).
- **A question script** for the nurse when opening an alert (FR-31).
- **Per-patient threshold overrides** by the surgeon at discharge (FR-4).
- **New-question markers and cadence-change notices** on the check-in (FR-8, FR-15).
- **Consent withdrawal** (NFR-14).
- **A signed-in screen for nurses to enter a check-in taken by phone.** The database already accepts a nurse as the source; nothing writes it. The PRD's recommended validation run (Section 7) depends on it.
- **Measurement** of latency, load, accessibility and device support (NFR-1, NFR-4, NFR-5, NFR-7).

5.2 To sell to more hospitals

The PRD scopes the MVP to one clinic and one procedure. Selling to small and mid-tier hospitals adds:

- **Onboarding.** A hospital created in the platform admin area starts with no WhatsApp wording, so its reminders are recorded as failed until a superadmin writes every message by hand. Each hospital also needs its own WhatsApp Business verification and Meta template approval, and its own emergency number (blocker 3).
- **More procedures.** Only the knee replacement ruleset exists. The architecture is procedure-agnostic, but each new procedure needs a surgeon-approved ruleset.
- **Already in place:** per-hospital data isolation, per-hospital WhatsApp accounts, and a platform admin for hospitals and rulesets.

SECTION 6

Regulatory and compliance

Data protection (DPDP). As the PRD notes, the DPDP Rules were notified on 13 November 2025, the Consent Manager framework takes effect on 13 November 2026, and the principal substantive provisions from 13 May 2027. Built: versioned, purpose-coded consent at enrolment, and per-hospital data isolation. Missing: consent withdrawal, a 72-hour breach notification process, and a log of who accessed which record.

Medical device regulation. Software that sorts patients by clinical risk may be regulated as a medical device under India's Medical Device Rules, 2017. Get a regulatory opinion before any hospital pilot; the answer may change what has to be documented and validated.

SECTION 7

Recommended path

Stage	Milestone	What it needs
Stage 0	**Demo on seeded data**	Ready today. The repository's run-simple-eras skill starts the app, resets the demo patients and drives a scripted walkthrough.
Stage 1	**Validation run (the PRD's recommendation)**	Rules engine and dashboard fed by nurses entering phone check-ins at one friendly clinic for two weeks, to prove the queue flags the right patients before the patient app matters. Needs blockers 2, 5 and 6, surgeon-approved thresholds, and the nurse entry screen.
Stage 2	**First real patients on the app**	All seven blockers closed.
Stage 3	**MVP as the PRD specifies**	Section 5.1 complete.
Stage 4	**More hospitals**	Section 5.2 complete, plus the regulatory position settled.

Remaining engineering effort

The PRD's own estimates for the workstreams that are still open add up to about 26 engineer-days: patient passcode and clinician authentication (6), SMS integration (2), reminders and SMS fallback (up to 4, as WhatsApp covers part), photo capture and upload (4), offline queue (5), and infrastructure, CI, storage and monitoring (5). That excludes work the PRD did not estimate: closing the simulator routes, the emergency number, the record-access log, translation, question scripts, per-patient overrides and the nurse entry screen.

> **THE DATE IS NOT SET BY ENGINEERING**
>
> As the PRD says, the critical path runs through surgeon sign-off, rostering a nurse to answer alerts, usability testing and the consent and breach processes. Start them now, in parallel with the software work.